



10 | DEATH BY BURRITO HOXTON SQUARE

Situated below a live music venue this is a great place to eat contemporary Mexican street food and maybe even enjoy a cocktail. The restaurant has a great atmosphere if you're young and like to enjoy a party. The food is reasonably priced, served on plastic plates with plastic cutlery, but the burritos and tacos are delicious. Beware if you're on a diet though. Even the smaller dishes of nachos, guacamole, black beans and chips will keep you dancing for a while to burn off those calories.

10 | SUPER TUSCAN WINE BAR AND KITCHEN SPITALFIELDS

This is a small and friendly wine bar tucked down a side street near the market. The décor is Mediterranean as is the menu. There's a selection of typically Tuscan dishes, like lentil or bean soup and bruschetta with porcini mushrooms, as well as all the usual pizza and pasta dishes. The food is cooked simply and tastes great, and there is such an authentic Italian atmosphere. This is a good place to meet up with friends and enjoy a glass of wine and an antipasto, although you'll probably find quite a few cities bankers doing that too.

10 | BACK IN 5 MINUTES BRICK LANE

You wouldn't find this restaurant unless you were looking. It's hidden behind a clothes shop. Walk through the shop and open a curtain at the back. It will take you down some stairs and into the 1970s-style dining room. Open from Wednesdays to Saturdays only, you can choose from a selection of three starters, three main courses and three desserts. While the food is seasonal and elegant, it isn't cheap. However, the atmosphere is so cosy and welcoming that you could easily forget you're in a restaurant at all. You feel as if you've been invited into someone's house for dinner.



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WRITING

A RESTAURANT REVIEW; LEARN TO LINK IDEAS

8 A Match headings a)–e) with questions 1–5 to complete the guide to writing a restaurant review.

- a) Information about the price
- b) Information about the menu
- c) Details of the restaurant
- d) Information about the service
- e) Information about the atmosphere

- 1 _____: Where is it? How can you contact them? How do you get there? What are the opening hours?
- 2 _____: What's the décor like? Is it child-friendly? Is it noisy? Is it romantic?
- 3 _____: What kind of food does it serve? Are there any specialities? Do they serve vegetarian food? Are there any particular dishes you recommend?
- 4 _____: Are the staff friendly? Do you have to wait a long time?
- 5 _____: Is it good value for money? How much does it cost per person? Are there any special offers?

B Read the reviews above. Which restaurant would you like to visit and why?

C Try to answer the questions in Exercise 8A for each restaurant.

9 A Look at the examples and answer questions 1–3.

*The food was **so** delicious **that** I didn't mind spending more than usual. It was **such** an enjoyable meal **that** I would recommend this restaurant to anybody.*

*It was **so** expensive **that** I wouldn't go back there **unless** I wanted to impress a client.*

***Although** it's a five-star restaurant, the service was appalling.*

***While** the staff are friendly, and the atmosphere is fun, the food isn't anything special.*

- 1 Which linking words do we use to connect ideas which contrast with each other?
- 2 Which do we use to talk about the consequences of a situation?
- 3 Which do we use to suggest a condition?

B Read the reviews in Exercise 8B again. Find and underline the linking words.

C Write sentences to connect the five pairs of ideas below. Use the words in brackets to help.

- 1 Starbucks has been very successful. Now they want to open new stores in China. (so)
- 2 The restaurant has had very bad reviews. Nobody wants to go there. (such)
- 3 The food was very bad. I will only go back there again if they get a new chef. (unless)
- 4 The food was delicious. The service was poor. (although)
- 5 The restaurant had a good atmosphere. The food was disappointing. (while)

10 Choose a restaurant in your town/city (or invent a restaurant). Write a short review (80–100 words). Use the guide in Exercise 8A to help you. Use the linking words in Exercise 9B to connect your ideas.

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